

L^AT_EX for Medieval Primary Source Handouts

Corey Stephan, Ph.D.

🏠 coreystephan.com

May 15, 2026

The world's best established software system for typesetting and document formatting, L^AT_EX has been popular throughout the mathematical and physical sciences for decades. The utility of L^AT_EX for scholars in humanities disciplines, however, tends to be overlooked.

L^AT_EX can be used for typesetting in (almost) all instances in which a scholar of humanities needs to present our materials elegantly.

I have prepared these slides in L^AT_EX – more quickly and with less frustration than would have been possible in graphical presentation program (e.g. LibreOffice Present).

This Tutorial

In this tutorial, I will introduce attendees to the use of LaTeX for a common task in medievalist scholarship, namely, typesetting texts with unusual line length and other organizational needs, such as primary texts with our original translations.

The specific example will be preparing a handout for a historical conference or class presentation with perfectly organized excerpts of a Byzantine Greek text and an original English translation in parallel.

I will walk attendees in sequence through setup, formatting, and, finally, viewing a document of this kind – talking about different approaches that one might take depending on needs, such as placing right-to-left (notably, Semitic) and left-to-right languages side-by-side.

I aim to inspire attendees to think about L^AT_EX as a highly flexible tool with a wider range of professional applications than it often is understood as having.

Getting Started with $\text{\LaTeX}$ in GNU/Linux

- ▶ [latex-project.org](https://www.latex-project.org)
 - ▶ official recommendations for $\text{\LaTeX}$ **distributions**
 - ▶ $\text{\LaTeX}$ **distributions** are bundles of closely interrelated software packages, including the $\text{\TeX}$ backend of $\text{\LaTeX}$, $\text{\LaTeX}$ itself, and hundreds to thousands of packages that make using $\text{\LaTeX}$ efficient and/or extend $\text{\LaTeX}$'s functionality
- ▶ *BSD or GNU/Linux? **TeXLive**
- ▶ MacOS? **MacTeX**
- ▶ Microsoft Windows? **TeXLive** or **MiKTeX**

TeXLive is available in the official package repositories of nearly all major *BSD and GNU/Linux operating systems.

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